

Bhagavad Gita - Chapter 13

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

143. Chapter 13 Verses 1-2

VERSE 13.1

अर्जुन उवाच ।
प्रकृतिं पुरुषं चैव क्षेत्रं क्षेत्रज्ञमेव च ।
एतद्वेदितुमिच्छामि ज्ञानं ज्ञेयं च केशव ॥ १ ॥*

arjuna uvācha

prakṛitiṁ puruṣhaṁ chaiva kṣhetraṁ kṣhetra-jñam eva cha
etat veditum ichchhāmi jñānaṁ jñeyaṁ cha keśhava

arjunaḥ uvācha—Arjun said; **prakṛitiṁ**—material nature; **puruṣhaṁ**—the enjoyer; **cha**—and; **eva**—indeed; **kṣhetraṁ**—the field of activities; **kṣhetra-jñam**—the knower of the field; **eva**—even; **cha**—also; **etat**—this; **veditum**—to know; **ichchhāmi**—I wish; **jñānam**—knowledge; **jñeyam**—the goal of knowledge; **cha**—and; **keśhava**—Krishna, the killer of the demon named Keshi

Arjuna said: Prakriti and Purusha, the Field and the Knower of the Field, knowledge and that which is to be known— all this, O Keśava, I desire to learn.

VERSE 13.2

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

इदं शरीरं कौन्तेय क्षेत्रमित्यभिधीयते ।

एतद्यो वेत्ति तं प्राहुः क्षेत्रज्ञ इति तद्विदः ॥२॥

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha

idaṁ śharīraṁ kaunteya kṣhetram ity abhidhīyate

etad yo vetti taṁ prāhuḥ kṣhetra-jña iti tad-vidaḥ

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Divine Lord said; **idam**—this; **śharīram**—body; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **kṣhetram**—the field of activities; **iti**—thus; **abhidhīyate**—is termed as; **etad**—this; **yaḥ**—one who; **vetti**—knows; **taṁ**—that person; **prāhuḥ**—is called; **kṣhetra-jñaḥ**—the knower of the field; **iti**—thus; **tad-vidaḥ**—those who discern the truth

The Lord said: This body, O son of Kunti, is called the Field, and he who knows it is called the Knower of the Field by those who describe them.

144. Chapter 13 Verse 2 (Cont'd)

VERSE 13.2

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

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The Lord said: This body, O son of Kunti, is called the Field, and he who knows it is called the Knower of the Field by those who describe them.

145. Chapter 13 Verse 2 (Cont'd)

VERSE 13.2

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एतद्यो वेत्ति तं प्राहुः क्षेत्रज्ञ इति तद्विदः ॥२॥

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The Lord said: This body, O son of Kunti, is called the Field, and he who knows it is called the Knower of the Field by those who describe them.

146. Chapter 13 Verse 2 (Cont'd)

VERSE 13.2

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

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एतद्यो वेत्ति तं प्राहुः क्षेत्रज्ञ इति तद्विदः ॥२॥

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha

idam śharīram kaunteya kṣhetram ity abhidhīyate

etad yo vetti tam prāhuḥ kṣhetra-jña iti tad-vidaḥ

śhrī-bhagavān uvācha—the Supreme Divine Lord said; **idam**—this; **śharīram**—body; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the son of Kunti; **kṣhetram**—the field of activities; **iti**—thus; **abhidhīyate**—is termed as; **etad**—this; **yaḥ**—one who; **vetti**—knows; **tam**—that person; **prāhuḥ**—is called; **kṣhetra-jñaḥ**—the knower of the field; **iti**—thus; **tat-vidaḥ**—those who discern the truth

The Lord said: This body, O son of Kunti, is called the Field, and he who knows it is called the Knower of the Field by those who describe them.

147. Chapter 13 Verses 3-6

VERSE 13.3

क्षेत्रज्ञं चापि मां विद्धि सर्वक्षेत्रेषु भारत ।
क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञयोर्ज्ञानं यत्तज्ज्ञानं मतं मम ॥३॥

kṣhetra-jñāṁ chāpi mām viddhi sarva-kṣhetreṣhu bhārata
kṣhetra-kṣhetrajñāyor jñānaṁ yat taj jñānaṁ mataṁ mama

kṣhetra-jñāṁ—the knower of the field; **cha**—also; **api**—only; **mām**—me; **viddhi**—know; **sarva**—all; **kṣhetreṣhu**—in individual fields of activities; **bhārata**—scion of Bharat; **kṣhetra**—the field of activities; **kṣhetra-jñāyoḥ**—of the knower of the field; **jñānaṁ**—understanding of; **yat**—which; **tat**—that; **jñānaṁ**—knowledge; **matam**—opinion; **mama**—my

O Arjuna! Know Me as the kshetrajna (Knower) in all the kshetras (bodies); Knowledge of the kshetra and kshetrajna is real Knowledge, according to My opinion.

VERSE 13.4

तत्क्षेत्रं यच्च यादृक्च यद्विकारि यतश्च यत् ।

स च यो यत्प्रभावश्च तत्समासेन मे शृणु ॥४॥

tat kṣhetraṁ yach cha yādr̥ik cha yad-vikāri yataśh cha yat
sa cha yo yat-prabhāvaśh cha tat samāsenā me śhr̥iṇu

tat—that; **kṣhetraṁ**—field of activities; **yat**—what; **cha**—and; **yādr̥ik**—its nature; **cha**—and; **yat-vikāri**—how change takes place in it; **yataḥ**—from what; **cha**—also; **yat**—what; **saḥ**—he; **cha**—also; **yaḥ**—who; **yat-prabhāvaḥ**—what his powers are; **cha**—and; **tat**—that; **samāsenā**—in summary; **me**—from me; **śhr̥iṇu**—listen

Hear briefly from Me what the Field is, what its nature is, what its modifications are, whence it comes, who its Knower is, and what His powers are.

VERSE 13.5

ऋषिभिर्बहुधा गीतं छन्दोभिर्विविधैः पृथक् ।
ब्रह्मसूत्रपदैश्चैव हेतुमद्भिर्विनिश्चितैः ॥ ५ ॥

ṛiṣhibhir bahudhā gītaṁ chhandobhir vividhaiḥ prithak
brahma-sūtra-padaish chaiva hetumadbhir viniśhchitaiḥ

ṛiṣhibhiḥ—by great sages; **bahudhā**—in manifold ways; **gītaṁ**—sung;
chhandobhiḥ—in Vedic hymns; **vividhaiḥ**—various; **prithak**—various;
brahma-sūtra—the Brahma Sūtra; **padaish**—by the hymns; **cha**—and; **eva**—
especially; **hetu-madbhiḥ**—with logic; **viniśhchitaiḥ**—conclusive evidence

**All this has been sung by sages in many and different ways,
in various distinctive hymns, and also in well reasoned and
convincing passages indicative of Brahman.**

VERSE 13.6

महाभूतान्यङ्ककारो बुद्धिरव्यक्त मेव च ।
इन्द्रियाणि दशैकं च पञ्च चेन्द्रियगोचराः ॥६॥

mahā-bhūtāny ahankāro buddhir avyaktam eva cha
indriyāṇi daśhaikam cha pañcha chendriya-gocharāḥ

mahā-bhūtāni—the (five) great elements; **ahankārah**—the ego; **buddhiḥ**—the intellect; **avyaktam**—the unmanifested primordial matter; **eva**—indeed; **cha**—and; **indriyāṇi**—the senses; **daśha-ekam**—eleven; **cha**—and; **pañcha**—five; **cha**—and; **indriya-go-charāḥ**—the (five) objects of the senses

The great elements, I-consciousness, understanding, and the unmanifested; the ten senses, the mind, the five objects of the senses;

148. Chapter 13 Verse 7

VERSE 13.7

इच्छा द्वेषः सुखं दुःखं सङ्घातश्चेतना धृतिः ।
एतत्क्षेत्रं समासेन सविकारमुदाहृतम् ॥७॥

ichchhā dveṣhaḥ sukhaṁ duḥkhaṁ saṅghātaśh chetanā dhṛtiḥ
etat kṣhetraṁ samāsenā sa-vikāram udāhṛitam

ichchhā—desire; **dveṣhaḥ**—aversion; **sukhaṁ**—happiness; **duḥkhaṁ**—misery; **saṅghātaḥ**—the aggregate; **chetanā**—the consciousness; **dhṛtiḥ**—the will; **etat**—all these; **kṣhetraṁ**—the field of activities; **samāsenā**—comprise of; **sa-vikāram**—with modifications; **udāhṛitam**—are said

Desire, hatred, pleasure, pain, the aggregate, intelligence, and fortitude— this, briefly stated, is the Field together with its modifications.

149. Chapter 13 Verse 7 (Cont'd)

VERSE 13.7

इच्छा द्वेषः सुखं दुःखं सङ्घातश्चेतना धृतिः ।
एतत्क्षेत्रं समासेन सविकारमुदाहृतम् ॥७॥

ichchhā dveṣhaḥ sukhaṁ duḥkhaṁ saṅghātaśh chetanā dhṛtiḥ
etat kṣhetraṁ samāsenā sa-vikāram udāhṛitam

ichchhā—desire; **dveṣhaḥ**—aversion; **sukhaṁ**—happiness; **duḥkhaṁ**—misery;
saṅghātaḥ—the aggregate; **chetanā**—the consciousness; **dhṛtiḥ**—the will; **etat**
—all these; **kṣhetraṁ**—the field of activities; **samāsenā**—comprise of; **sa-**
vikāram—with modifications; **udāhṛitam**—are said

**Desire, hatred, pleasure, pain, the aggregate, intelligence,
and fortitude— this, briefly stated, is the Field together with
its modifications.**

150. Chapter 13 Verse 7 (Cont'd)

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इच्छा द्वेषः सुखं दुःखं सङ्घातश्चेतना धृतिः ।
एतत्क्षेत्रं समासेन सविकारमुदाहृतम् ॥७॥

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saṅghātaḥ—the aggregate; **chetanā**—the consciousness; **dhṛtiḥ**—the will; **etat**
—all these; **kṣhetraṁ**—the field of activities; **samāsenā**—comprise of; **sa-**
vikāram—with modifications; **udāhṛitam**—are said

**Desire, hatred, pleasure, pain, the aggregate, intelligence,
and fortitude— this, briefly stated, is the Field together with
its modifications.**

151. Chapter 13 Verses 8-9

VERSE 13.8-9

अमानित्वमदम्भित्वमहिंसा क्षान्तिरार्जवम् ।
आचार्योपासनं शौचं स्थैर्यमात्मविनिग्रहः ॥८॥
इन्द्रियार्थेषु वैराग्यमनहङ्कार एव च ।
जन्ममृत्युजराव्याधिदुःखदोषानुदर्शनम् ॥९॥

amānitvam adambhitvam ahinsā kṣhāntir ārjavam
āchāryopāsanam śhaucham sthairyam ātma-vinigrahaḥ
indriyārtheṣhu vairāgyam anahankāra eva cha
janma-mṛityu-jarā-vyādhi-duḥkha-doṣhānudarśhanam

amānitvam—humbleness; **adambhitvam**—freedom from hypocrisy; **ahinsā**—non-violence; **kṣhāntiḥ**—forgiveness; **ārjavam**—simplicity; **āchārya-upāsanam**—service of the Guru; **śhaucham**—cleanliness of body and mind; **sthairyam**—steadfastness; **ātma-vinigrahaḥ**—self-control; **indriya-artheṣhu**—toward objects of the senses; **vairāgyam**—dispassion; **anahankāraḥ**—absence of egotism; **eva cha**—and also; **janma**—of birth; **mṛityu**—death; **jarā**—old age; **vyādhi**—disease; **duḥkha**—evils; **doṣha**—faults; **anudarśhanam**—perception;

Humbleness; freedom from hypocrisy; non-violence; forgiveness; simplicity; service of the Guru; cleanliness of body and mind; steadfastness; and self-control; dispassion toward the objects of the senses; absence of egotism; keeping in mind the evils of birth, disease, old age, and death;

152. Chapter 13 Verse 10

VERSE 13.10

असक्तिरनभिष्वङ्गः पुत्रदारगृहादिषु ।
नित्यं च समचित्तत्वमिष्टानिष्टोपपत्तिषु ॥ 10 ॥

asaktir anabhiṣhvaṅgaḥ putra-dāra-grīhādiṣhu
nityaṁ cha sama-chittatvam iṣṭāniṣṭhopapattiṣhu

asaktiḥ—non-attachment; **anabhiṣhvaṅgaḥ**—absence of craving; **putra**—children; **dāra**—spouse; **grīha-ādiṣhu**—home, etc; **nityam**—constant; **cha**—and; **sama-chittatvam**—even-mindedness; **iṣṭa**—the desirable; **aniṣṭa**—undesirable; **upapattiṣhu**—having obtained;

non-attachment; absence of clinging to spouse, children, home, and so on; even-mindedness amidst desired and undesired events in life;

153. Chapter 13 Verses 11-12

VERSE 13.11-12

मयि चानन्ययोगेन भक्तिरव्यभिचारिणी ।
विविक्तदेशसेवित्वमरतिर्जनसंसदि ॥ 11 ॥
अध्यात्मज्ञाननित्यत्वं तत्त्वज्ञानार्थदर्शनम् ।
एतज्ज्ञानमिति प्रोक्तमज्ञानं यदतोऽन्यथा ॥ 12 ॥

mayi chānanya-yogena bhaktir avyabhichārīṇī
vivikta-deśha-sevitvam aratir jana-sansadi
adhyātma-jñāna-nityatvaṁ tattva-jñānārtha-darśhanam
etaḥ jñānam iti proktam ajñānaṁ yad ato 'nyathā

mayi—toward Me; **cha**—also; **ananya-yogena**—exclusively united; **bhaktiḥ**—devotion; **avyabhichārīṇī**—constant; **vivikta**—solitary; **deśha**—places; **sevitvam**—inclination for; **aratiḥ**—aversion; **jana-sansadi**—for mundane society; **adhyātma**—spiritual; **jñāna**—knowledge; **nityatvam**—constancy; **tattva-jñāna**—knowledge of spiritual principles; **artha**—for; **darśhanam**—philosophy; **etat**—all this; **jñānam**—knowledge; **iti**—thus; **proktam**—declared; **ajñānam**—ignorance; **yat**—what; **ataḥ**—to this; **anyathā**—contrary

constant and exclusive devotion toward Me; an inclination for solitary places and an aversion for mundane society; constancy in spiritual knowledge; and philosophical pursuit of the Absolute Truth—all these I declare to be knowledge, and what is contrary to it, I call ignorance.

154. Chapter 13 Verses 13-14

VERSE 13.13

ज्ञेयं यत्तत्प्रवक्ष्यामि यज्ज्ञात्वामृतमश्नुते ।
अनादिमत्परं ब्रह्म न सत्तन्नासदुच्यते ॥ 13 ॥

jñeyam yat tat pravakṣhyāmi yaj jñātvāmṛitam aśhnute
anādi mat-param brahma na sat tan nāsad uchyate

jñeyam—ought to be known; **yat**—which; **tat**—that; **pravakṣhyāmi**—I shall now reveal; **yaj**—which; **jñātvā**—knowing; **amṛitam**—immortality; **aśhnute**—one achieves; **anādi**—beginningless; **mat-param**—subordinate to Me; **brahma**—Brahman; **na**—not; **sat**—existent; **tat**—that; **na**—not; **asat**—non-existent; **uchyate**—is called

I will now describe that which ought to be known, through the knowing of which one attains Immortality. It is the Supreme Brahman, which is without beginning and is said to be neither being nor non-being.

VERSE 13.14

सर्वतः पाणिपादं तत्सर्वतोऽक्षिशिरोमुखम् ।
सर्वतः श्रुतिमल्लोके सर्वमावृत्य तिष्ठति ॥ 14 ॥

sarvataḥ pāṇi-pādaṁ tat sarvato 'kṣhi-śhiro-mukham
sarvataḥ śhrutimal loke sarvam āvṛitya tiṣṭhati

sarvataḥ—everywhere; **pāṇi**—hands; **pādam**—feet; **tat**—that; **sarvataḥ**—
everywhere; **akṣhi**—eyes; **śhiraḥ**—heads; **mukham**—faces; **sarvataḥ**—
everywhere; **śhruti-mat**—having ears; **loke**—in the universe; **sarvam**—
everything; **āvṛitya**—pervades; **tiṣṭhati**—exists

**Its hands and feet are everywhere; Its eyes, heads, and faces
are everywhere; Its ears are everywhere; Its existence
envelops all.**

155. Chapter 13 Verse 15

VERSE 13.15

सर्वेन्द्रियगुणाभासं सर्वेन्द्रियविवर्जितम् ।
असक्तं सर्वभृच्चैव निर्गुणं गुणभोक्तृ च ॥ 15 ॥

sarvendriya-guṇābhāsaṁ sarvendriya-vivarjitam
asaktaṁ sarva-bhṛich chaiva nirguṇaṁ guṇa-bhoktṛi cha

sarva—all; indriya—senses; guṇa—sense-objects; ābhāsaṁ—the perciever;
sarva—all; indriya—senses; vivarjitam—devoid of; asaktaṁ—unattached;
sarva-bhṛit—the sustainer of all; cha—yet; eva—indeed; nirguṇam—beyond
the three modes of material nature; guṇa-bhoktṛi—the enjoyer of the three
modes of material nature; cha—although;

**It shines through the functions of all the senses, and yet It is
devoid of senses. It is unattached, and yet It sustains all. It is
devoid of gunas, and yet It enjoys them.**

156. Chapter 13 Verses 16-18

VERSE 13.16-18

बहिरन्तश्च भूतानामचरं चरमेव च ।
सूक्ष्मत्वात्तदविज्ञेयं दूरस्थं चान्तिके च तत् ॥ 16 ॥
अविभक्तं च भूतेषु विभक्तमिव च स्थितम् ।
भूतभर्तृ च तज्ज्ञेयं ग्रसिष्णु प्रभविष्णु च ॥ 17 ॥
ज्योतिषामपि तज्ज्योतिस्तमसः परमुच्यते ।
ज्ञानं ज्ञेयं ज्ञानगम्यं हृदि सर्वस्य विष्ठितम् ॥ 18 ॥

bahir antaśh cha bhūtānām acharaṁ charam eva cha
sūkṣhmatvāt tad avijñeyaṁ dūra-sthaṁ chāntike cha tat

avibhaktaṁ cha bhūteṣhu vibhaktam iva cha sthitam
bhūta-bhartrī cha taj jñeyaṁ grasiṣṇu prabhaviṣṇu cha

It is without and within all beings. It is unmoving and also moving. It is incomprehensible because It is subtle. It is far away, and yet It is near. It is indivisible, and yet It is, as it were, divided among beings. That Knowable Brahman is the Sustainer of all beings, and also their Devourer and Generator. The Light even of lights, It is said to be beyond darkness. As knowledge, the object of knowledge, and the goal of knowledge, It is set firm in the hearts of all.

157. Chapter 13 Verse 17 (Cont'd)

VERSE 13.17

अविभक्तं च भूतेषु विभक्तमिव च स्थितम् ।
भूतभर्तृ च तज्ज्ञेयं ग्रसिष्णु प्रभविष्णु च ॥ 17 ॥

avibhaktam cha bhūteṣhu vibhaktam iva cha sthitam
bhūta-bharṭṛi cha taj jñeyam grasiṣṇu prabhaviṣṇu cha

avibhaktam—indivisible; **cha**—although; **bhūteṣhu**—amongst living beings; **vibhaktam**—divided; **iva**—apparently; **cha**—yet; **sthitam**—situated; **bhūta-bharṭṛi**—the Sustainer of all beings; **cha**—also; **taj**—that; **jñeyam**—to be known; **grasiṣṇu**—the Annihilator; **prabhaviṣṇu**—the Creator; **cha**—and;

It is indivisible, and yet It is, as it were, divided among beings. That Knowable Brahman is the Sustainer of all beings, and also their Devourer and Generator.

158. Chapter 13 Verses 19-21

VERSE 13.19

इति क्षेत्रं तथा ज्ञानं ज्ञेयं चोक्तं समासतः ।
मद्भक्त एतद्विज्ञाय मद्भावायोपपद्यते ॥ 19 ॥

iti kṣhetraṁ tathā jñānaṁ jñeyaṁ choktaṁ samāsaṭḥ
mad-bhakta etad vijñāya mad-bhāvāyopapadyate

iti—thus; **kṣhetraṁ**—the nature of the field; **tathā**—and; **jñānaṁ**—the meaning of knowledge; **jñeyaṁ**—the object of knowledge; **cha**—and; **uktam**—revealed; **samāsaṭḥ**—in summary; **mad-bhaktaḥ**—my devotees; **etat**—this; **vijñāya**—having understood; **mad-bhāvāya**—my divine nature; **upapadyate**—attain

Thus briefly have been set forth the Field and also knowledge and the object of knowledge. My devotee who understands this becomes worthy of My state.

VERSE 13.20

प्रकृतिं पुरुषं चैव विद्व्यनादी उभावपि ।

विकारांश्च गुणांश्चैव विद्वि प्रकृतिसम्भवान् ॥ 20 ॥

prakṛitiṁ puruṣhaṁ chaiva viddhy anādī ubhāv api

vikārānś cha guṇānś chaiva viddhi prakṛiti-sambhavān

prakṛitiṁ—material nature; **puruṣhaṁ**—the individual souls; **cha**—and; **eva**—indeed; **viddhi**—know; **anādī**—beginningless; **ubhau**—both; **api**—and; **vikārān**—transformations (of the body); **cha**—also; **guṇān**—the three modes of nature; **cha**—and; **eva**—indeed; **viddhi**—know; **prakṛiti**—material energy; **sambhavān**—produced by

**Know that Prakriti and Purusha are both without beginning;
and know, too, that all forms and gunas are born of Prakriti.**

VERSE 13.21

कार्यकारणकर्तृत्वे हेतुः प्रकृतिरुच्यते ।
पुरुषः सुखदुःखानां भोक्तृत्वे हेतुरुच्यते ॥ 21 ॥

kārya-kāraṇa-karṭṛitve hetuḥ prakṛitir uchyate
puruṣhaḥ sukha-duḥkhānām bhokṭṛitve hetur uchyate

kārya—effect; **kāraṇa**—cause; **karṭṛitve**—in the matter of creation; **hetuḥ**—the medium; **prakṛitiḥ**—the material energy; **uchyate**—is said to be; **puruṣhaḥ**—the individual soul; **sukha-duḥkhānām**—of happiness and distress; **bhokṭṛitve**—in experiencing; **hetuḥ**—is responsible; **uchyate**—is said to be

Prakriti is said to be the cause of the generation of the body and the organs, and Purusha is said to be the cause of the experience of pleasure and pain.

159. Chapter 13 Verses 22-23

VERSE 13.22

पुरुषः प्रकृतिस्थो हि भुङ्क्ते प्रकृतिजान्गुणान् ।
कारणं गुणसङ्गोऽस्य सदसद्योनिजन्मसु ॥ २२ ॥

puruṣhaḥ prakṛiti-stho hi bhuṅkte prakṛiti-jān guṇān
kāraṇaṁ guṇa-saṅgo 'sya sad-asat-yoni-janmasu

puruṣhaḥ—the individual soul; **prakṛiti-sthaḥ**—seated in the material energy; **hi**—indeed; **bhuṅkte**—desires to enjoy; **prakṛiti-jān**—produced by the material energy; **guṇān**—the three modes of nature; **kāraṇaṁ**—the cause; **guṇa-saṅgaḥ**—the attachment (to three guṇas); **asya**—of its; **sat-asat-yoni**—in superior and inferior wombs; **janmasu**—of birth

Purusha, embodied in Prakriti, experiences the gunas born of Prakriti. It is attachment to these gunas that is the cause of His birth in good and evil wombs.

VERSE 13.23

उपद्रष्टानुमन्ता च भर्ता भोक्ता महेश्वरः ।
परमात्मेति चाप्युक्तो देहे ऽस्मिन्पुरुषः परः ॥ 23 ॥

upadraṣṭānumantā cha bhartā bhoktā maheśhvaraḥ
paramātmēti chāpy ukto dehe 'smin puruṣhaḥ paraḥ

upadraṣṭā—the witness; **anumantā**—the permitter; **cha**—and; **bhartā**—the supporter; **bhoktā**—the transcendental enjoyer; **mahā-īśhvaraḥ**—the ultimate controller; **parama-ātmā**—Supreme Soul; **iti**—that; **cha api**—and also; **uktaḥ**—is said; **dehe**—within the body; **asmin**—this; **puruṣhaḥ paraḥ**—the Supreme Lord

The Supreme Spirit in the body is said to be the one who is the Witness and the Approver, the Supporter and the Enjoyer, and who is the Sovereign Lord and the Highest Self.

160. Chapter 13 Verses 24-25

VERSE 13.24

य एवं वेत्ति पुरुषं प्रकृतिं च गुणैः सह ।
सर्वथा वर्तमानोऽपि न स भूयोऽभिजायते ॥ 24 ॥

ya evaṁ vetti puruṣhaṁ prakṛitiṁ cha guṇaiḥ saha
sarvathā vartamāno 'pi na sa bhūyo 'bhijāyate

yaḥ—who; **evam**—thus; **vetti**—understand; **puruṣham**—Puruṣh; **prakṛitim**—the material nature; **cha**—and; **guṇaiḥ**—the three modes of nature; **saha**—with; **sarvathā**—in every way; **vartamānaḥ**—situated; **api**—although; **na**—not; **saḥ**—they; **bhūyaḥ**—again; **abhijāyate**—take birth

He who thus knows Purusha and Prakriti, along with the gunas, is not born again. He will be liberated regardless of his present condition.

VERSE 13.25

ध्यानेनात्मनि पश्यन्ति केचिदात्मानमात्मना ।
अन्ये साङ्ख्येन योगेन कर्मयोगेन चापरे ॥ 25 ॥

dhyānenātmani paśhyanti kechid ātmānam ātmanā
anye sāṅkhyena yogena karma-yogena chāpare

dhyānena—through meditation; **ātmani**—within one’s heart; **paśhyanti**—perceive; **kechid**—some; **ātmānam**—the Supreme soul; **ātmanā**—by the mind; **anye**—others; **sāṅkhyena**—through cultivation of knowledge; **yogena**—the yog system; **karma-yogena**—union with God with through path of action; **cha**—and; **apare**—others

Some by meditation perceive the Self in themselves through the mind, some by devotion to knowledge, and some by devotion to work.

161. Chapter 13 Verses 26-28

VERSE 13.26

अन्ये त्वेवमजानन्तः श्रुत्वान्येभ्य उपासते ।
तेऽपि चातितरन्त्येव मृत्युं श्रुतिपरायणाः ॥ 26 ॥

anye tv evam ajānantaḥ śhrutvānyebhya upāsate
te 'pi chātitaranty eva mṛityum śhruti-parāyaṇāḥ

anye—others; **tu**—still; **evam**—thus; **ajānantaḥ**—those who are unaware (of spiritual paths); **śhrutvā**—by hearing; **anyebhyaḥ**—from others; **upāsate**—begin to worship; **te**—they; **api**—also; **cha**—and; **atitaranti**—cross over; **eva**—even; **mṛityum**—death; **śhruti-parāyaṇāḥ**—devotion to hearing (from saints)

**And there are yet some who do not know It by these means.
They hear of It from others and worship. They too pass
beyond death through their devotion to what they have
heard.**

यावत्सञ्जायते किञ्चित्सत्त्वं स्थावरजङ्गमम् ।

क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञसंयोगात्तद्विद्धि भरतर्षभ ॥ 27 ॥

yāvat sañjāyate kiñchit sattvaṁ sthāvara-jaṅgamam

kṣhetra-kṣhetrajña-sanyogāt tad viddhi bharatarṣhabha

yāvat—whatever; sañjāyate—manifesting; kiñchit—anything; sattvam—being; sthāvara—unmoving; jaṅgamam—moving; kṣhetra—field of activities; kṣhetra-jña—knower of the field; sanyogāt—combination of; tat—that; viddhi—know; bharata-ṛṣhabha—best of the Bharatas

Whatever is born— whether animate or inanimate— know, O Bhārata prince, that it is through union of the Field and the Knower of the Field.

VERSE 13.28

समं सर्वेषु भूतेषु तिष्ठन्तं परमेश्वरम् ।

विनश्यत्स्वविनश्यन्तं यः पश्यति स पश्यति ॥ 28 ॥

samaṁ sarveṣhu bhūteṣhu tiṣṭhantaṁ parameśhvaram
vinaśhyatsv avinaśhyantaṁ yaḥ paśhyati sa paśhyati

samam—equally; **sarveṣhu**—in all; **bhūteṣhu**—beings; **tiṣṭhan-tam**—accompanying; **parama-īśhvaram**—Supreme Soul; **vinaśhyatsu**—amongst the perishable; **avinaśhyantaṁ**—the imperishable; **yaḥ**—who; **paśhyati**—see; **saḥ**—they; **paśhyati**—perceive

**He who sees the Supreme Lord abiding alike in all beings,
and not perishing when they perish— verily he alone sees.**

162. Chapter 13 Verses 29-34

VERSE 13.29

समं पश्यन्हि सर्वत्र समवस्थितमीश्वरम् ।
न हिनस्त्यात्मनात्मानं ततो याति परां गतिम् ॥ 29 ॥

samaṁ paśhyan hi sarvatra samavasthitam īśhvaram
na hinasty ātmanātmānam tato yāti parāṁ gatim

samam—equally; **paśhyan**—see; **hi**—indeed; **sarvatra**—everywhere;
samavasthitam—equally present; **īśhvaram**—God as the Supreme soul; **na**—do
not; **hinasti**—degrade; **ātmanā**—by one’s mind; **ātmānam**—the self; **tataḥ**—
thereby; **yāti**—reach; **parām**—the supreme; **gatim**—destination

**Because he sees the Lord present alike everywhere, he does
not injure Self by self, and thus he reaches the supreme
state.**

VERSE 13.30

प्रकृत्यैव च कर्माणि क्रियमाणानि सर्वशः ।
यः पश्यति तथात्मानमकर्तारं स पश्यति ॥ 30 ॥

prakṛityaiva cha karmāṇi kriyamāṇāni sarvaśhaḥ
yaḥ paśhyati tathātmānam akartāram sa paśhyati

prakṛityā—by material nature; **eva**—truly; **cha**—also; **karmāṇi**—actions;
kriyamāṇāni—are performed; **sarvaśhaḥ**—all; **yaḥ**—who; **paśhyati**—see; **tathā**
—also; **ātmānam**—(embodied) soul; **akartāram**—actionless; **saḥ**—they;
paśhyati—see

**He who sees that all actions are done only by Prakriti and
that the Self is actionless— verily, he alone sees.**

VERSE 13.31

यदा भूतपृथग्भावमेकस्थमनुपश्यति ।
तत एव च विस्तारं ब्रह्म सम्पद्यते तदा ॥ 31 ॥

yadā bhūta-prīthag-bhāvam eka-stham anupaśhyati
tata eva cha vistāraṁ brahma sampadyate tadā

yadā—when; bhūta—living entities; prīthag-bhāvam—diverse variety; eka-stham—situated in the same place; anupaśhyati—see; tataḥ—thereafter; eva—indeed; cha—and; vistāram—born from; brahma—Brahman; sampadyate—(they) attain; tadā—then

When he sees that the manifold nature of beings is centred in the One and that all evolution is from that One alone, he becomes one with Brahman.

अनादित्वान्निर्गुणत्वात्परमात्मायमव्ययः ।
शरीरस्थोऽपि कौन्तेय न करोति न लिप्यते ॥ 32 ॥

anāditvān nirguṇatvāt paramātmāyam avyayaḥ
śharīra-stho 'pi kaunteya na karoti na lipyate

anāditvāt—being without beginning; **nirguṇatvāt**—being devoid of any material qualities; **parama**—the Supreme; **ātmā**—soul; **ayam**—this; **avyayaḥ**—imperishable; **śharīra-sthaḥ**—dwelling in the body; **api**—although; **kaunteya**—Arjun, the the son of Kunti; **na**—neither; **karoti**—acts; **na**—nor; **lipyate**—is tainted

Having no beginning and possessing no gunas, this supreme and imperishable Self, O son of Kunti, neither acts nor is stained by action even while dwelling in the body.

VERSE 13.33

यथा सर्वगतं सौक्ष्म्यादाकाशं नोपलिप्यते ।
सर्वत्रावस्थितो देहे तथात्मा नोपलिप्यते ॥ 33 ॥

yathā sarva-gatam saukṣhmyād ākāśham nopalipyate
sarvatrāvasthito dehe tathātmā nopalipyate

yathā—as; sarva-gatam—all-pervading; saukṣhmyāt—due to subtlety;
ākāśham—the space; na—not; upalipyate—is contaminated; sarvatra—
everywhere; avasthitaḥ—situated; dehe—the body; tathā—similarly; ātmā—the
soul; na—not; upalipyate—is contaminated

**As the ākāśa that pervades all things is not stained, because
of its subtlety, even so the Self dwelling in the body
everywhere is not stained.**

VERSE 13.34

यथा प्रकाशयत्येकः कृत्स्नं लोकमिमं रविः ।
क्षेत्रं क्षेत्री तथा कृत्स्नं प्रकाशयति भारत ॥ ३४ ॥

yathā prakāśhayaty ekaḥ kṛitsnam lokam imam raviḥ
kṣhetram kṣhetrī tathā kṛitsnam prakāśhayati bhārata

yathā—as; prakāśhayati—illumines; ekaḥ—one; kṛitsnam—entire; lokam—solar system; imam—this; raviḥ—sun; kṣhetram—the body; kṣhetrī—the soul; tathā—so; kṛitsnam—entire; prakāśhayati—illumine; bhārata—Arjun, the son of Bharat

As the one sun illumines the whole world, so does He who dwells in the body, O Bhārata, illumine the whole body.

क्षेत्रक्षेत्रज्ञयोरेवमन्तरं ज्ञानचक्षुषा ।
भूतप्रकृतिमोक्षं च ये विदुर्यान्ति ते परम् ॥ 35 ॥

kṣhetra-kṣhetrajñayor evam antaram jñāna-chakṣhuṣhā
bhūta-prakṛiti-mokṣham cha ye vidur yānti te param

kṣhetra—the body; **kṣhetra-jñayoḥ**—of the knower of the body; **evam**—thus; **antaram**—the difference; **jñāna-chakṣhuṣhā**—with the eyes of knowledge; **bhūta**—the living entity; **prakṛiti-mokṣham**—release from material nature; **cha**—and; **ye**—who; **viduḥ**—know; **yānti**—approach; **te**—they; **param**—the Supreme

They who perceive with the eye of wisdom this distinction between the Field and the Knower of the Field, and also the deliverance from Prakriti, the cause of all beings— they attain the Supreme.